amidst a flourishing friendship, a remarkable story depicted in the 2017 British movie *Victoria & Abdul*.

From 1857, the number of lascars and ayahs circulating between India and Britain rose to tens of thousands, and the number of students studying in British universities grew from four in 1845 to around 700 in 1910.[27] Student migration to Britain began to account for the who's who of the Indian national movement as they were exposed to Western ideas and quickly recognized the mismatch between the theory and practice of democracy. In the early 20th century, some lascars began to 'jump ship' at ports and find jobs in cities like London, Manchester and Birmingham, and set a path of chain migration that populated these cities with many South Asians in the latter half of the century. The two world wars also brought thousands of Indians to Europe as soldiers, some of whom went to Britain for recuperation.

Post-Independence, many Indians decided to move to their 'imperial motherland' along with the returning British officers. Better wages was one driving force but more importantly, for many, it was a means to escape the horrors of Partition-related communal violence. Punjabis from the districts associated with the Great Indian Migration Wave dominated this migration due to their previous military links and settled in Southall. Mirpur district in present-day Pakistan and Sylhet in present-day Bangladesh emerged as major migrant-sending regions from South Asia, building on previous connections cultivated by the lascars. World War II also took a heavy toll on the male population of Britain and raised the demand for labour in many sectors, which was duly filled by South Asians in mining, mills, transport and even the National Health Service.

Stringent immigration laws in the 1960s restricted the flow of labour migrants from India and persuaded many circulatory migrants to settle in Britain permanently. A new wave of tens of thousands of East African-Indian migrants emerged in the late 60s and early 70s, dominated by Gujarati traders, who quickly set up shop in Britain. In subsequent decades, Gujaratis and Punjabis would draw in many more migrants from their states in India to realize their dreams and aspirations, travelling by airplanes